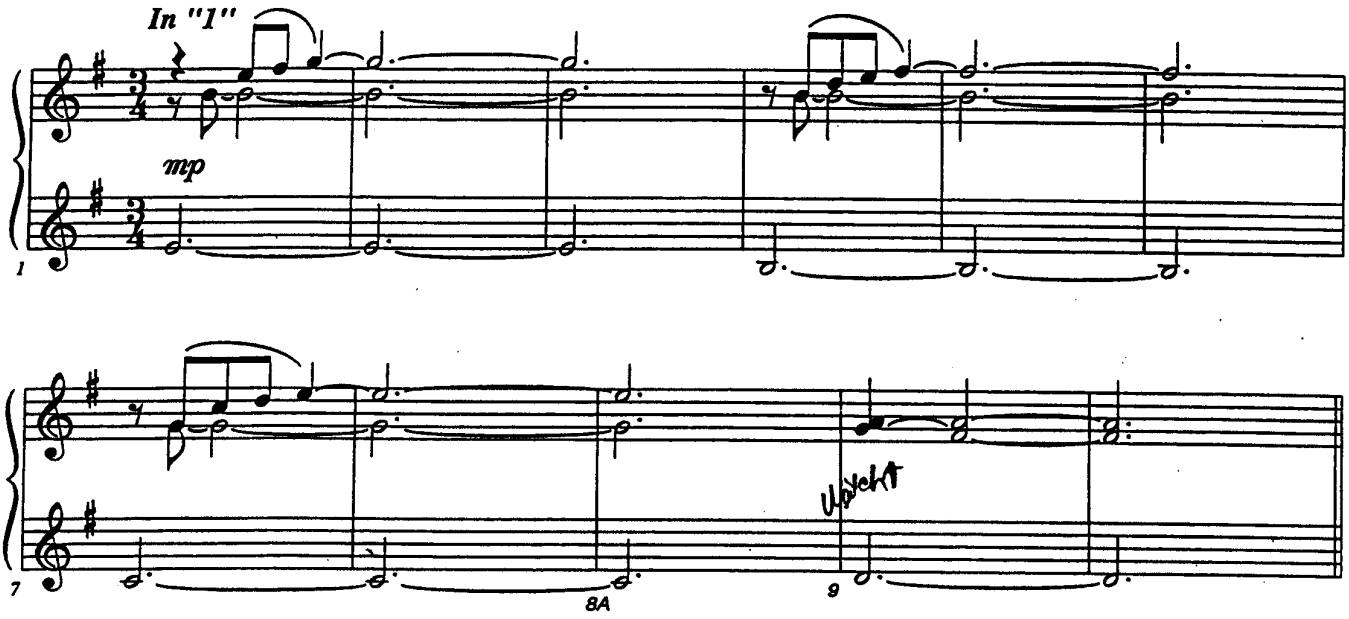
Back To Before

(Mother, Ensemble Women)

Cue:
FATHER: "Everything will be fine, Mother."
(FATHER exits.)



V.S.

(Simply, conversationally)

MOTHER:

There was a time our hap - pi - ness seemed ne - ver - en - ding.

Solo harp:

p a capella

11

I was so sure that where we were hea-ding was right.

17

Life was a road so cer - tain and straight and un - ben - ding.

23

Our lit - tle road with ne - ver a cross-road in sight.

Harp

Clarinet

(Orch in:)

29


Back in the days when we spoke in ci - vi - lized voic - es,
35
wo - men in white and stur - dy young men at the oar.
41
Back in the days when I let you make all my choic - es...
poco rit.
47
We can ne - ver go back to be -
(roll down)
(A Tempo)
poco rit.
53

A Tempo


fore.
57
There was a time my feet were so so - lid - ly plant - ed.
63
You'd sail a - way while I turned my back to the sea.
69
I was con - tent, a prin - cess a - sleep and en - chant - ed.
75


If I had dreams, then I let you dream them for me.
81
Back in the days when ev - 'ry - thing seemed so much clear - er.
87
Wo - men in white who knew what their lives held in store.
93
Where are they now, those wo - men who stared from the mir -
99

2/21/98


ror?
We can ne - ver go back to be -
poco rit.
104
A Tempo poco piu mosso
fore.
poco piu mosso
109
Ped.
MOTHER:
There are
ENSEMBLE WOMEN: (Offstage:)
p
(Ah)
113
Ped.


peo - ple out there un - a - fraid of re -
(Ah)
117
veal - ing that they might have a
(Ah)
121
feel - ing, or they might have been
div.
(Ah)
125


wrong.
There are
129
peo - ple out there un - a - fraid to feel
(Ah)
133
sor - row, un - a - fraid of to -
div.
(Ah)
137

3/18/98


mor - row, un - a - fraid to be
(Ah)
(Ah)
141
poco a poco cresc.
weak...
un - a - fraid to be
(Ah)
subp
poco a poco cresc.
145
poco rall.
rall.
strong.
poco rall.
div.
div.
rall.
(Ah)
(Ah)
cresc.
rall.
149

2/21/98


A Tempo
There was a time when you were the per - son in mo - tion.
(Ah)
153
I was your wife. It nev - er oc - curred to want more.
rit.
159
A Little Slower
mp
You were my sky, my moon and my stars and my o - cean.
poco rit.
mp
poco rit.
165

A Tempo
(Slightly Faster than Tempo Primo)




be - fore.
gliss.
(Tempo)
poco rall.
184
189
sfz